

SoSe 26 Computer Graphics Solutions

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Preface

This is a Quarto book.

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1 Sheet 1

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1.1 Assignment 1.1

a) $|\text{Pixel}| = 3840 \times 2160 = 829440$

The whole display is generated in $t = \frac{1}{f} = \frac{1}{60} s$

$\Rightarrow$ Generation of a single pixel can take at most:

$$t_{max} = \frac{1}{3840 \times 2160 \times 60} s \approx 2ns$$

b) Data load of 24 bits per pixel is due to three color channels Red, Green, and Blue, each 8 bit, i.e. 1B. Therefore there are 8 Bytes per pixel and 3840×2160 pixels in total. Since the display is regenerated every $1/60$ seconds, we have:

$$B = 3B \times 3840 \times 2160 \times 60 \frac{1}{s} \\ \approx 1.4GB/s$$

1.2 Assignment 1.2

a) There are three types of light-sensitive receptors,

- S: corresponding to blue
- M: corresponding to green
- L corresponding to red but the perception of color is calculated simply as superposition of three channels but rather as two channels combination of pairs of opposing colors

- b) To focus (or zoom in this context) means to reduce the field of vision, and reducing the field of vision corresponds to a smaller solid angle. The smaller the solid angle is, the less light arrives at the camera lens or human eye through the telescope, which makes the object appear dimmer, or not bright enough.
- c) metamers are color pairs that look or are perceived identically to the human eye, although they emit different light spectra, because they produce the same response in the three cone types (L, M, S)

2 Sheet 2

2.1 Assignment 1

- a)
 - Vector-based advantages:
 - resolution independent
 - Vector-based disadvantages:
 - image build-up is difficult in complex scenes
 - Raster-based advantages:
 - repeated image build-up independent of scene complexity
 - Raster-based disadvantages:
 - Moire effects due to finite number of pixels
- b) a spectral color, or a monochromatic color, is light produced by the light of single wavelength in the visible spectrum
- c)
- d) mach bands are an optical illusion where we perceive extra-bright and extra-dark bands near the boundary between two regions with different luminance gradients

a receptive field have usually a center-surround structure where light in the center excites a neuron, while the light in the surrounding region inhibits it, or vice versa.

Mach bands arise because these center-surround receptive fields perform a local contrast enhancement. Near a luminance edge, one receptive field may receive more excitation than inhibition, making the side look brighter, or vice versa. e) three operations: i)

relation to YIQ

in the YIQ model the Y channel is calculated approximately as:

$$Y = 0.3 R + 0.6G + 0.1 B$$

where we see that green contributes the most and blue the least. This corresponds roughly to the human perception of brightness - it is strongest around green-yellow region and weakest in the blue region, due to S cells contributing close to nothing to the perception of brightness.

I and Q channels carry color-difference information. They do not correspond exactly to the biological opponent channels, but they similarly separate color information from brightness detail - human eye is much more sensitive to contrast than to color difference

1) The light spectrum is given as

$$P(\lambda) = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2\pi\sigma^2}} \exp\left(-\frac{(\lambda - \mu)^2}{2\sigma^2}\right) W$$

Is a Gaussian / normal distribution shape:

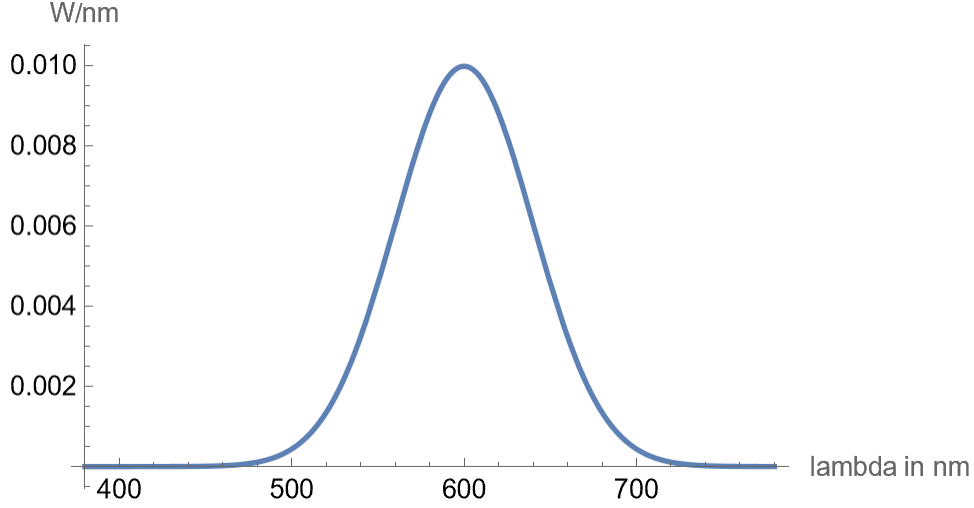


Figure 2.1: $P(\lambda)$

And the color matching functions are given as:

$$\bar{x}(\lambda) = 1.065 \exp\left(-\frac{1}{2} \left(\frac{\lambda - 595.8}{33.33}\right)^2\right) + 0.366 \exp\left(-\frac{1}{2} \left(\frac{\lambda - 446.8}{19.44}\right)^2\right)$$

$$\bar{y}(\lambda) = 1.014 \exp\left(-\frac{1}{2} \left(\frac{\ln \lambda - \ln 556.3}{0.075}\right)^2\right)$$

$$\bar{z}(\lambda) = 1.839 \exp\left(-\frac{1}{2} \left(\frac{\ln \lambda - \ln 449.8}{0.051}\right)^2\right)$$

which can be plotted as follows (together with a scaled version of $P(\lambda)$):

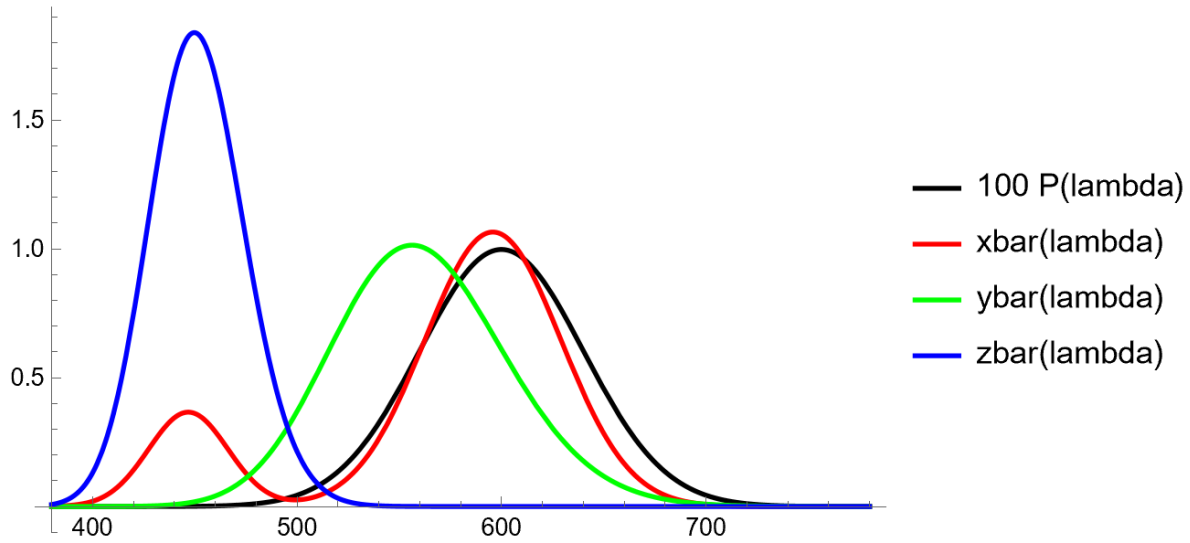


Figure 2.2: x, y, z

To compute X, Y, Z we compute the integrals:

$$X = \int_{\lambda} \bar{x}(\lambda) P(\lambda) d\lambda,$$

$$Y = \int_{\lambda} \bar{y}(\lambda) P(\lambda) d\lambda,$$

$$Z = \int_{\lambda} \bar{z}(\lambda) P(\lambda) d\lambda.$$

We can use a symbolic or numerical mathematics software. In our case we used mathematica where we computed the integrals with the following code:

First we define the functions:

```
sigma = 40;
mu = 600;

P[lambda_] := 1/Sqrt[2 Pi sigma^2] Exp[-(lambda - mu)^2/(2 sigma^2)];

xbar[lambda_] :=
  1.065 Exp[-1/2 ((lambda - 595.8)/33.33)^2] +
  0.366 Exp[-1/2 ((lambda - 446.8)/19.44)^2];

ybar[lambda_] :=
```



```

1.014 Exp[-1/2 ((Log[lambda] - Log[556.3])/0.075)^2];

zbar[lambda_] :=
1.839 Exp[-1/2 ((Log[lambda] - Log[449.8])/0.051)^2];

```

Then we compute the integrals with:

```

X = NIntegrate[xbar[lambda] P[lambda], {lambda, 380, 780}];
Y = NIntegrate[ybar[lambda] P[lambda], {lambda, 380, 780}];
Z = NIntegrate[zbar[lambda] P[lambda], {lambda, 380, 780}];

```

and find

$$\begin{aligned}
X &\approx 0.679966 \\
Y &\approx 0.569252 \\
Z &\approx 0.00561767
\end{aligned}$$

and finally we compute the x, y values as:

$$\begin{aligned}
x &= \frac{X}{X+Y+Z} \approx 0.541881 \\
y &= \frac{Y}{X+Y+Z} \approx 0.453642
\end{aligned}$$

To compute linear RGB from XYZ we use the following linear transformation:

$$\begin{pmatrix} R_{\text{lin}} \\ G_{\text{lin}} \\ B_{\text{lin}} \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 3.2406 & -1.5372 & -0.4986 \\ -0.9689 & 1.8758 & 0.0415 \\ 0.0557 & -0.2040 & 1.0570 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} X \\ Y \\ Z \end{pmatrix}.$$

We achieve this with the following mathematica code:

```

XYZtoLinearSRGB[{X_, Y_, Z_}] := {
  3.2406 X - 1.5372 Y - 0.4986 Z,
  -0.9689 X + 1.8758 Y + 0.0415 Z,
  0.0557 X - 0.2040 Y + 1.0570 Z
}

{R, G, B} = XYZtoLinearSRGB[{X, Y, Z}]

```

and obtain:

$$\begin{aligned}R &\approx 1.33 \\G &\approx 0.41 \\B &\approx -0.07\end{aligned}$$

Here R and B are outside of representable RGB gamut. Clipping them we get

$$\begin{aligned}R &\approx 1 \\G &\approx 0.41 \\B &\approx 0\end{aligned}$$

Converting this to $[0, 255]$ scale we get

$$(R, G, B) = (255, 171, 0)$$

This is a bright yellow-orange color, with no blue

3 2021 solutions

3.1 Task 1

- a) raster graphics vs vector graphics:
- b) explain & motivate following:

- i) Up vector:

The **up vector** specifies which direction should appear upward in the camera image. Together with the viewing direction, it determines the camera coordinate system and removes the otherwise undetermined rotation around the viewing axis (camera roll). It must not be parallel to the viewing direction.

- ii) **Double buffering:**

Yes—the main relevant slide is **CG06_1, slide 129**; slide 130 extends it to stereoscopic rendering.

Double buffering: Two color buffers are used. The **front buffer** contains the complete image currently displayed, while the next frame is rendered invisibly into the **back buffer**. When rendering is finished, the buffers are swapped. This prevents incomplete, partially rendered images from being displayed and decouples rendering from the screen refresh.

- iii)

- iv) **backface culling: Backface culling:** For each triangle, its front and back faces are distinguished, commonly using the order of its projected vertices: counterclockwise winding usually indicates a front face. Triangles facing away from the camera are discarded before rasterization. For closed meshes, these back faces are normally hidden by front faces anyway, so culling them avoids unnecessary rendering work. It must be disabled or adjusted when viewing a mesh from the inside or rendering two-sided surfaces.

- c) explain how vertex normals can be computed from a given mesh. In that context explain the issues that can arise from degenerate triangles

For every triangle, compute its face normal using the cross product of two edges,

$$\mathbf{n}_f = (\mathbf{p}_2 - \mathbf{p}_1) \times (\mathbf{p}_3 - \mathbf{p}_1).$$

For each vertex, sum the normals of all adjacent faces—optionally weighted by their areas or corner angles—and normalize the resulting vector to obtain the vertex normal.

If a triangle has a zero-length edge, its cross product is the zero vector. This vector cannot be normalized and may produce undefined values that contaminate the vertex-normal calculation. Such degenerate triangles should therefore be detected and ignored or removed.

- d) rendering sharp edges can be done by introducing multiple normal per vertex. Does this work equally well for gouraud and phong

The approach works for both methods, but not with equal shading quality:

- **Gouraud shading:** Illumination is calculated at each vertex. The different normals assigned to the same geometric position produce different vertex colors for the adjacent faces. These colors are interpolated separately within each face, preserving the discontinuity at the sharp edge. However, lighting effects between vertices—especially small specular highlights—may be missed.
- **Phong shading:** The separate normals are interpolated within their respective faces, and illumination is calculated for every fragment. The normal remains discontinuous across the edge, while lighting within each face is evaluated more accurately.

Thus, both can represent sharp edges, but Phong shading generally renders their illumination more accurately, at greater computational cost. [Phong's per-pixel shading formulation](#) also reflects this accuracy-cost trade-off.

- e) two projection types, explain the difference:

The two widely used projection types are:

- **Orthographic (parallel) projection:** Projection rays are parallel. An object's apparent size does not decrease with distance, and parallel lines remain parallel.
- **Perspective projection:** Projection rays meet at the camera's projection centre. Distant objects appear smaller, producing perspective foreshortening and a more realistic impression of depth.

- f) explain the reasons for aliasing and artifact it leads to

Aliasing is caused by sampling a continuous image or signal at an insufficient spatial or temporal frequency. In particular, if the sampling frequency is not greater than twice the highest signal frequency, high-frequency details are incorrectly represented as lower, artificial frequencies. Sharp object boundaries are especially problematic because they contain very high frequencies.

Typical artifacts include **jagged or staircase-shaped edges**, **Moiré patterns**, distorted fine details, and flickering or crawling patterns in animations.

g) role of perspective division and its relation to dehomogenization

After the projection transformation, a point is represented in homogeneous clip coordinates as

$$(x_h, y_h, z_h, w_h).$$

Perspective division divides the first three coordinates by (w_h):

$$(x_h, y_h, z_h, w_h) \mapsto \left(\frac{x_h}{w_h}, \frac{y_h}{w_h}, \frac{z_h}{w_h} \right).$$

Since (w_h) depends on the point's depth, this division makes distant objects appear smaller and maps the perspective view frustum to the normalized unit cube.

Perspective division is therefore precisely the **dehomogenization** performed after the projection transformation; in the course, this complete step is also called the **normalization transformation**.

h) rendering equation

- i) explain different parts of the rendering equation
- ii) how if f typically named, how many parameters (dimensions) does it have?
- iii) how many parameters, dimensions does the isotropic version of f have
- iv) explain why this equations

3.1.1 Task 1(h)

The rendering equation is

(i) Components

- **(A)** $L(\mathbf{x}, \omega)$: total outgoing radiance leaving point $\mathbf{x}$ in direction ω .
- **(B)** $E(\mathbf{x}, \omega)$: radiance emitted by the surface itself in direction ω .
- **(C)** $f(\mathbf{x}, \omega_i \rightarrow \omega)$: describes what proportion of light arriving from ω_i is reflected toward ω . The integral sums reflected light arriving from all directions in the positive hemisphere Ω^+ . The factor $\cos \theta_i$ accounts for the smaller effective surface area presented to light arriving at a grazing angle.

(ii) f is called the **bidirectional reflectance distribution function (BRDF)**. At a fixed surface point, it is four-dimensional: two angles specify the incoming direction and two specify the outgoing direction,

$$f(\theta_i, \phi_i, \theta_o, \phi_o).$$

(iii) An isotropic BRDF is invariant under simultaneous rotation of both directions around the surface normal. Only the relative azimuth matters, so it is three-dimensional:

$$f(\theta_i, \theta_o, \phi_i - \phi_o).$$

(iv) The equation is recursive because the incoming radiance at $\mathbf{x}$ is outgoing radiance from another visible surface point. That outgoing radiance is itself determined by the rendering equation and depends on light arriving there from still other surfaces. In ray tracing, this leads to recursively tracing secondary rays until a light source is reached or a termination condition is applied.

3.2 Task 2 Color

a) What is the role of K in CMYK, motivate it.

In **CMYK**, (K) is the **key (black) ink**. It replaces the common black component of cyan, magenta, and yellow,

$$K = \min(C, M, Y),$$

because combining CMY inks does not produce a clean, fully covering black in practice. Using separate black ink also improves contrast and saves colored ink.

b) The chromaticity diagram omits **brightness (luminance), represented by (Y)**. It displays only the chromaticity coordinates x and y , which describe color independent of brightness.

Note that the omitted quantity is not lowercase z , because $z = 1 - x - y$ is already determined by x and y .

i Review of X, Y Z

(X), (Y), and (Z) are three **tristimulus values**: numerical coordinates describing a perceived color in the CIE XYZ color space.

They are computed from the light spectrum ($S(\lambda)$) using the CIE standard-observer

color-matching functions:

$$X = \int S(\lambda), \bar{x}(\lambda), d\lambda, \quad Y = \int S(\lambda), \bar{y}(\lambda), d\lambda, \quad Z = \int S(\lambda), \bar{z}(\lambda), d\lambda.$$

Their roles are:

- Y was deliberately designed to represent **luminance**, or perceived brightness.
- X and Z , together with Y , carry the remaining chromatic information.

They should not be interpreted simply as red, green, and blue intensities. XYZ uses mathematically defined, partly “imaginary” primaries chosen so that visible colors can be represented conveniently with nonnegative values.

The chromaticity coordinates remove overall intensity through normalization:

$$x = \frac{X}{X + Y + Z}, \quad y = \frac{Y}{X + Y + Z}, \quad z = \frac{Z}{X + Y + Z} = 1 - x - y.$$

Thus x and y describe chromaticity, while uppercase Y retains the brightness information.

- c) is the human visual system more sensitive to color variation or brightness variation?
Explain how this motivates image compression approaches?

The human visual system is more sensitive to variations in **luminance (brightness)** than to variations in **chrominance (color)**.

Image compression therefore commonly converts RGB into separate luminance and chrominance components, such as Y , C_b , and C_r . The luminance channel Y is retained at higher resolution and precision, while the chrominance channels can be subsampled or quantized more strongly. This reduces the data size while causing relatively little perceptible loss of image quality.

- d) MacAdam ellipses? how would they look like for a perfectly perceptually uniform color space?

MacAdam ellipses represent regions around reference colors in which color differences are not perceptible, or are below a chosen just-noticeable-difference threshold. Colors inside an ellipse appear indistinguishable from the color at its centre.

In the CIE (xy) diagram, their different sizes and orientations show that equal geometric distances do not correspond to equal perceived color differences. In a perfectly perceptually uniform color space, all MacAdam ellipses would become **circles of equal size**, independent of their position.

- e) what is metamerism

Metamerism means that two physically different spectral distributions can produce the same responses in the three types of cone cells and therefore be perceived as the same color. Such spectra are called **metamers**.

f) explain Mach bands, including the role of receptive fields?

Mach bands are illusory bright and dark bands perceived near boundaries or changes in a luminance gradient, even though those bands are not present in the actual intensity distribution.

They arise from **centre-surround receptive fields** and lateral inhibition in the visual system. A receptor's response depends not only on light at its centre but also on the brightness of the surrounding region. Near a boundary:

- on the bright side, part of the surrounding region is darker, causing less inhibition and an exaggerated bright response;
- on the dark side, part of the surrounding region is brighter, causing stronger inhibition and an exaggerated dark response.

The visual system therefore enhances the luminance gradient, making boundaries easier to detect but producing the Mach-band illusion.

i functions of centre-surround structure

The complementary surround makes the receptive field measure **local contrast**, rather than simply absolute light intensity.

An ON-centre/OFF-surround receptive field behaves approximately like

$$R \approx I_{\text{centre}} - \text{average}(I_{\text{surround}}).$$

Therefore:

- If the entire region is uniformly bright, centre and surround largely cancel, producing only a weak response.
- If the centre is brighter than its surroundings, the neuron responds strongly.
- If the centre is darker, an OFF-centre/ON-surround neuron responds strongly.

If the surround had the same effect as the centre, the neuron would mainly average nearby light—a blurring operation. Giving the surround the opposite effect instead performs a spatial comparison and emphasizes changes.

This achieves several useful functions:

- **Edge detection:** object boundaries produce large local brightness differences.
- **Resistance to overall illumination:** a uniformly brighter scene affects centre and surround similarly and largely cancels out.

- **Efficient encoding:** neighbouring image values are usually similar, so transmitting mainly their differences reduces redundant information.
- **Detection of both polarities:** ON-centre cells detect brightness increases; OFF-centre cells detect decreases.

Biologically, this structure arises from lateral connections in retinal circuitry, especially involving horizontal cells. Mach bands are essentially a side effect of this useful contrast-enhancement system: it sometimes exaggerates a real luminance gradient into illusory bright and dark bands.

g)

3.2.1 Task 2(g)

3.2.2 Task 2(g)

i) For n additive primary colors, the display gamut is the **convex hull** of their chromaticity coordinates. In two-dimensional chromaticity space, this is a convex polygon with at most n vertices; three primaries normally produce a triangle.

ii) Spectral, meaning monochromatic, colors lie on the **curved horseshoe-shaped boundary**, called the spectral locus. The straight lower boundary between E and F is excluded.

iii) The straight boundary from E to F is the **line of purples**. Purple colors are not spectral colors; they are additive mixtures of the red and violet colors at the two endpoints. Mixtures of two colors lie on the straight line segment connecting their chromaticity coordinates.

iv) C , located approximately at $x = y = \frac{1}{3}$, represents achromatic **white**. Because C lies on the segment between A and D , it can be produced by mixing A and D in the appropriate proportions. Thus, A and D are complementary colors.

v) B also lies on the segment between A and D , so it is an additive mixture of them. Since B lies between A and the white point C , it can also be understood as a less saturated version of A : it has the same dominant hue as A , mixed with some of its complementary color D .

i Complementary colors in the horse-shoe diagram

Complementary colors are two colors whose additive mixture, in suitable intensity proportions, produces a chosen achromatic white.

In the chromaticity diagram, additive mixtures of two colors lie on the straight segment connecting them. Therefore, to find a complementary color:

1. Start at color A .

2. Draw a line from A through the chosen white point C .
3. Extend it to the opposite side of the horseshoe boundary.
4. The intersection point D is the maximally saturated complementary color of A relative to that white point.

In the exam figure, A , C , and D are collinear, with C between A and D . Hence a suitable mixture satisfies

$$C = (1 - t)A + tD,$$

so A and D are complementary. They do not normally need to be mixed in equal amounts: equal proportions occur only if C is exactly the midpoint of A and D .

The complementary point may lie either on the curved spectral locus or on the straight line of purples. Thus, the complement of a spectral color is not necessarily another spectral color.

A revised answer for (iv) would be:

C , located approximately at $x = y = \frac{1}{3}$, represents achromatic white. Since C lies on the line segment connecting A and D , an additive mixture of A and D in suitable proportions produces white. Therefore, A and D are complementary colors relative to the white point C .

3.3 Task 3

a) explain

i) ray generation

Ray generation is the construction of a primary viewing ray for each pixel or image sample. In the pinhole-camera model, the ray begins at the camera position e and passes through the corresponding point s on the image plane:

$$\mathbf{r}(t) = \mathbf{e} + t(\mathbf{s} - \mathbf{e}), \quad t \geq 0.$$

The nearest scene intersection along this ray determines the surface visible at that pixel and is used to calculate its color.

ii)